

FOR THE TEACHER • THE NEWS DESK PACK

Teacher Guide



Why the frames work, how to pick a story nobody will call you about, a script and a strong-answer example for every frame, one rubric that scores any frame, and what to do when it goes sideways.

WHY THIS PACK

A news story is a claim, a trade, a rule, a price, or a permission slip in disguise. Ten frames give students ten ways to take one apart. Check it. Weigh it. Write the rule for it. Follow the money. Do the math. Then sort what got copied, ask who paid, decide what an AI may touch, and rate what would hurt to lose. The pack takes any story, but not every frame fits every story; the table in the lesson plan matches each story to its frame. Every frame is a numbered method a student can run without you, so on News Desk Day you play editor, not answer key. The story changes every week. The method doesn't. Frame 1 is the Fact Desk method from Hallucination Hunters (Lesson 3 of the AI Literacy unit), opened up to any story. The pack stands alone.

In this guide: p.1 why the pack works and how to pick a safe story · p.2–3 a script per frame (three quotable lines, a strong answer) · p.4 the rubric, when it goes sideways, the standards map. The lesson plan holds the timing (Open 5 · Read 10 · Frame 20 · Share-out 10), the bell-ringer, and the story table.

HOW TO PICK A SAFE STORY

- 1. Two sources or it doesn't exist.** Before you print a story, find it reported by two outlets that did not copy each other. If you can only find it once, it's a rumor, not a story. This is the rule Frame 1 teaches, so let students see you follow it. No devices? Read the story aloud, then read the second outlet's opening lines aloud. That is the room's second source.
- 2. "Alleged" for any lawsuit.** A lawsuit is a list of claims a court hasn't decided. Say "the musicians allege," never "the company copied." If the story is the verdict, say what the court decided and stop there.
- 3. Officeholders as officeholders.** "The mayor announced." "The schools chancellor said." Not the name. Students frame the decision; the person is not the lesson. That keeps the room on the rule and off the election.
- 4. If students must pick a political side, skip it.** A story about a party, a candidate, or a vote is out. A story about a school rule, a price, a free app, a hack, or a new tool is in. The lesson plan's story table is the "in" list.
- 5. Never a story that shames a family.** No crime stories with names, no viral videos of kids, nothing a student in your room could be related to. A theft with no suspects is fine (Frame 10). A person is not.

Fit check, two minutes: read the first paragraph aloud. If you'd stop to explain three words, plan to read the whole story aloud in class. Keep the story to one page. Then name the frame from the table; if you can't, the story isn't ready. Pick the frame before you print. Story is a video? Write a three-sentence description of what it shows and says, and print that.

Where a story comes from in five minutes: a local paper's front page, a public broadcaster, the science or tech section, a museum newsletter, the school newsletter. Never a screenshot of a post as the source (rule 1). Print the text, not the page. The photos usually aren't yours to copy.

USING THE WORKED EXAMPLES

The four worked examples are dated September 2026 and labeled with the outlets that reported each story. The summaries are written in our own words, carry no figures, and name companies as companies and officeholders as officeholders. Under each one, the frame is filled in as a strong student would fill it, with answers trimmed to fit the frame's write-in space, and a short note on why that frame. Show one, then hand students a fresh story. When an example ages out, the frame doesn't.

Scripts, Frames 1–5. Each paragraph gives you three lines to say while you circulate and what a strong frame looks like when you collect it. Say the lines as written; they are the method in a sentence.

🔍 FRAME 1 • FACT DESK — Is it true?

Students underline claims, mark them C or S, name a second source for each C, and stamp RUN, FIX, or KILL.

"Underline anything with a name, a date, a number, a place, or a quote in it. If it can be checked, it's a claim."

"A second source is not where you first saw it. Same video, same account, same AI: doesn't count." "The stamp is the easy part. Your evidence is the grade."

Strong answer: three or more claims copied exactly, each with a specific kind of second source (a museum site, an encyclopedia entry, the team's own schedule), one stamp, and an evidence line that says whether the story's point still stands. "I'd Google it" earns nothing. "I'd Google it and open the university's own page" earns credit.

🔍 FRAME 2 • THE TRADE — Who wins, who loses?

Students name the change in one sentence, then who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong later, and make a call. **"Somebody always loses something. If your loser box is empty, you haven't looked yet." "Later counts. What goes wrong in a year, not just on day one?" "Your call has to name the win or the loss that decided it."**

Strong answer: the winner and the loser are specific groups, not "people"; the loss is real even when the change is good (a free app that costs you your attention); "what could go wrong" is a chain of events, not one word; one box is checked and the "because" names the side of the trade that decided it.

🔍 FRAME 3 • WRITE THE RULE — What should the rule be?

Students write the story's question, draft three different rules, grid each one (helps, hurts, costs), fix any clash and number them as a policy, then defend one in three sentences. **"We're not deciding who was right. We're writing the rule we'd want." "Three rules that are actually different. If two of yours would do the same thing, you have two." "A policy is rules that work together. Could the people in charge use all three of yours?"**

Strong answer: a real yes-or-no or how-much question; three rules in three different shapes (strict, loose, in the middle, creative); every grid cell filled, including a cost in money, time, or freedom; three rules that don't clash, numbered in the order they'd happen, and a fix line that says what changed; a three-sentence defense whose proof sentence points at the story or the grid, never at "everyone knows."

🔍 FRAME 4 • WHO PAYS FOR FREE? — If it's free, who pays?

Students name the free thing and what it costs to run, write one gain and one loss for users under each of seven ways to pay, then pick one and say why. **"Free means someone else is paying. Find them." "Every row has a loss. If a way to pay looks perfect, you've missed the loss." "Pick the loss you can live with, not the one that sounds nice."**

Strong answer: running costs named (servers, the people who keep it up); a gain and a loss in all seven rows, written from the user's side; one pick; a why that names the loss and says why it's bearable. Watch for "Ads: no loss." The loss is attention, tracking, and slower pages.

🔍 FRAME 5 • UNIT RATE RECEIPT — Which deal is really cheaper?

Students list three options (price and amount), pick one unit, find the cost per unit, and match three people to their best option. **"The sticker price is what they want you to compare. Cost per unit is what you actually pay." "Same unit for all three, or the math is a lie." "Cheapest per unit isn't always best. Best for whom?"**

Strong answer: the unit is named once and used three times; the division is shown for each option and rounded to cents; each person is matched with a reason that uses the numbers (the light user would pay for hours they never use). Accept a calculator. Don't accept an answer with no unit on it.

Practice prices for Frame 5 (made up, not news): a music app at \$6 for 1 month, \$60 for 12 months, or \$15 a month for a 3-person family plan. Per person per month: \$6.00, \$5.00, \$5.00. The light user still picks one month.

Scripts, Frames 6–10. Same shape: three lines to say, then what a strong frame looks like when you collect it.

Q **FRAME 6 • PERCENT CHANGE CARD** — How big is the change, really?

Students fill the card (old, new, difference, percent), make a call on how big the change is, turn the new price into hours of work, and split it over an eight-week save-up plan. **"Difference divided by the OLD price. Old is the whole; you're finding what part of it changed."** **"Now turn it into hours. How long would you have to work for this?"** **"Eight weeks. Where does each week's money come from? 'Somewhere' is not a place."**

Strong answer: a correct percent with the division shown and rounded; one call checked; a pay rate they could really earn (chores, babysitting, a first job) and the hours it implies; eight weekly amounts that add up to the new price; money sources that aren't "my parents" every week. This is the CCSS Math 7.RP.A.3 item: the percent is computed, not guessed. If the number isn't a price (jobs, players), the money lines say what the change means for one person.

Q **FRAME 7 • COPY, STYLE, OR PERSON?** — What got copied?

Students learn the three kinds (a work, a style, a person), sort eight rows plus the copying in their own story, and draw their line. **"A work is a thing. A style is a way. A person is a who."** **"Tracing a drawing copies a work. Drawing like someone copies a style. Same pencil, different rule."** **"Your line has to survive your own story. Sort row 9, then test your line on it."**

Strong answer: sort key 1 work · 2 style · 3 person · 4 work · 5 work · 6 person · 7 style · 8 work (a dance routine is a work; the talent show is the allowed kind of copying). Accept a defended "style" on rows 5 and 8. Row 9 holds the story's own copying, sorted. The line says when copying is fine (learning, credit, making your own new thing) and where it crosses (a person's voice, face, or name; a whole work sold as yours).

Q **FRAME 8 • SOURCE CHECK** — Who's telling me this, and why?

Students name who made the source, who paid for it, and what they gain, then sort five statements into facts you could check and opinions it pushes. **"A source can be telling the truth and still be selling you something."** **"Who paid for the study is the first fact about the study."** **"A fact can be checked. An opinion is wanted. Which is this sentence?"**

Strong answer: maker and payer are specific (the company's own report; a group funded by the industry it studies); the gain is concrete (more users, a better price, a friendlier rule); five statements copied, with at least one fact and one opinion among them; a trust line that says "trust the count, question the conclusion" rather than a flat yes or no.

Q **FRAME 9 • PERMISSION SLIP** — What may an AI helper do on its own?

Students add two things the AI in their story could do (rows 9 and 10), mark all ten as Allow, Check first, or Deny, give a one-line reason for each, and find the risky combo. **"Allow is for things you can undo. Can't undo it? Then it's Check first or Deny."** **"Because it could _____. Finish the sentence or you haven't got a reason."** **"Two rows that are harmless alone. Together, what could they do?"**

Strong answer: rows 9 and 10 come from the story; every row checked, with a reason that names the harm (could spend money I can't get back; could read something private); deleting, paying, passwords, and location land on Check first or Deny; the combo is two specific rows and a chain (read my messages + send as me = it answers a private message as me).

Q **FRAME 10 • RISK GRID** — What would hurt most to lose?

Students list five things worth protecting, rate cost to replace and how bad if gone (1 to 3 each), multiply for a score, and spend 10 coins on two protections. **"You can't protect everything. That's the point of the grid."** **"Cheap to buy isn't the same as easy to replace. A game save costs nothing, and you can't buy it back. Rate both."** **"Ten coins, two protections, and not every pair fits. What did you leave unprotected, and can you live with that?"**

Strong answer: five things with honest ratings (a phone: cost 3, bad 3, score 9; a water bottle: 1×1); protections bought for the top scores and inside the budget (a passcode plus a backup copy is $3 + 7$, exactly the 10 coins); a sentence naming what stays unprotected and why that's acceptable. A backup plus insurance is 16 coins and cannot be bought, so a student who wants both has to give one up and say so.

🔍 ONE RUBRIC — SCORES ANY FRAME

	STRONG (3)	GETTING THERE (2)	NOT YET (1)
Claim	One clear verdict, call, or pick, checked once, that answers the frame's question.	A call, but hedged, or two boxes checked.	No call, or a call that misses the question.
Evidence	Names something specific: a claim, a second source, or a number worked out on the page.	Points at the story in general ("it says so").	Opinion only. No source, no number.
Method followed	Every numbered step done in order, and it shows: C and S marks, grid cells, math.	A step skipped or out of order, but the result holds.	Jumped to the boxes; steps blank.
Said plainly	The "So what?" says why it matters to someone their age, in words they'd say aloud.	Matters to "people" or "society."	Blank, or repeats the headline.

12 possible. 10–12 strong · 7–9 getting there, one fix · below 7, redo one step with you. The claim on Frame 6 is "My call"; on Frames 5 and 7, the match or the line (score the clearest one). Score the evidence, not the answer: two students can disagree and both score 12.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

The story a student brings is about a person. → "We frame the change, not the person. What changed?" If nothing changed, it's gossip, not news. Pick another.

"It's true, it was on the news." Or the second source is the same AI or account. → "Which outlet? Name one more that didn't copy it. Same voice twice doesn't count." (Frame 1, step 3)

The room splits into two loud sides. → "Score the evidence, not the side. Who named a source, followed a step, and said it plainly?" Then move to Share-out.

The math frames stall (5, 6). → Do row one on the board together, then hand it back. In Frame 5 the stall is nearly always the unit. In Frame 6 it's dividing by the new price instead of the old.

The story turns out to be political after all. → Stop, name rule 4 from p.1, and swap in your backup story. Frames survive a swap. You lose five minutes, not the period.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: Frame 1 step 3 (name a second source) and Frame 8 steps 1–3 (who made it, who paid, what they gain). Assessed: Frame 1's "Second source" column, Frame 8's "Would I trust it?" line; rubric row "Evidence."*
- **CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: Frame 1 steps 1–2 (underline and mark claims) and Frame 8 step 4 (a fact you could check vs. an opinion it pushes). Assessed: Frame 1's verdict plus "My evidence" line; Frame 8's five-statement table.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.1** — Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence. *Taught: Frame 3 step 5 (defend one rule: the rule, the reason, the proof) and Frame 2 step 5 (my call, because). Assessed: Frame 3's three-sentence defense; rubric rows "Claim" and "Evidence."*
- **CSTA 2-IC-20** — Compare tradeoffs associated with computing technologies that affect people's everyday activities and career options. *Taught: Frame 2 when the story is about a technology (story table row 2) and Frame 9 (allow, check first, deny). Assessed: Frame 2's "My call" box and "because" line; Frame 9's ten reasons and the risky combo.*
- **CCSS Math 7.RP.A.3** — Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems. Examples: simple interest, tax, markups and markdowns, gratuities and commissions, fees, percent increase and decrease, percent error. *Taught: Frame 6 steps 2–5 (difference, percent change, hours of work, an eight-week plan). Assessed: Frame 6's percent cell, its "Show it" line, and the save-up table; rubric row "Method followed."*

Your purchase (or free download) grants ONE teacher a license for their own classroom. Share the store link, not the file. Questions or a problem with this resource? Ask on the listing before leaving a review — most fixes take a day.